

DECREE #04 — KINTSUGI PARTITION

Decree ID: FGE-DECREE-04 **Version:** 1.0 **Date:** 2026-06-13 **Status:** RULED — Pending Operator Lock **Owner:** Black Governance **Authority:** Canon Operator (operator-only lock) **Impacted Planets:** MATERIAL MATRIX, KINTSUGI NARRATIVE **Impacted Products:** Triptych Folio, Codex Envelope, Lookbook Slipcase, Vault Box **Deconfliction Tag:** LAYER (not MERGE, not BRANCH) **Supersedes:** Open dispute “Kintsugi: Material vs Narrative vs Doctrine?”

1. THE DISPUTE

Kintsugi has been simultaneously claimed by three layers:

- **MATERIAL** wants it as a registered material (MAT-003, gold-laced fracture, render properties).
- **KINTSUGI NARRATIVE** wants it as the core of the narrative engine (post-Fracture repair logic, story spine).
- **DOCTRINE ATLAS** wants it as a symbolic law (repair, beauty in brokenness).

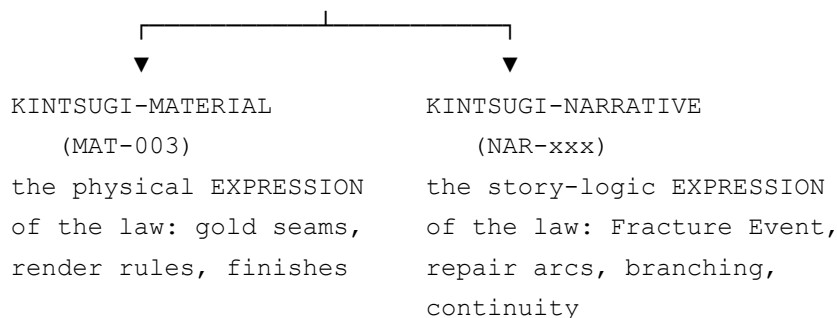
The dispute was framed as a **partition** — assign Kintsugi to one layer. This framing is unresolvable, because Kintsugi genuinely operates in all three. Forcing it into one box breaks the other two, which is why the decree has stayed open and blocked ~18 downstream registry lines through MAT-003.

2. THE RULING

Kintsugi is not partitioned. Kintsugi is stratified.

Kintsugi exists at all three layers as **three distinctly-typed objects** bound by a one-directional reference chain. There is one Kintsugi *concept*, three Kintsugi *records*, and exactly one authoritative parent.

```
KINTSUGI-DOCTRINE (SYM-xxx)           ← authoritative parent
  the symbolic LAW: repair,
  beauty in brokenness, the
  "broken but stronger" principle
  |
```



Reference direction is strict and one-way: Material and Narrative *reference* Doctrine. Doctrine references nothing below it. A change to the symbolic law (Doctrine) can propagate downward to Material and Narrative; a change to a render finish (Material) or a story beat (Narrative) **cannot** propagate upward or sideways. This prevents a packaging decision from silently rewriting story canon, and a story branch from silently changing a physical finish.

This is the same fix applied to the doctrine-as-single-entity ambiguity one level up: **one identity, multiple typed access patterns, one source of truth.**

3. THE THREE RECORDS

3.1 KINTSUGI-DOCTRINE — the parent

- **Layer:** Symbolic Doctrine (Doctrine Atlas §3)
- **Proposed ID:** SYM-010 (assign next available in SYM range)
- **Type:** `doctrine.symbolic`
- **Holds:** The law only. Repair, resilience, deliberate imperfection as strength, “broken but stronger.” No render specs. No story beats.
- **Authority:** Changes here require Canon Operator lock and propagate downward to both children.
- **Status target:** Canon-Locked

3.2 KINTSUGI-MATERIAL — physical expression

- **Layer:** Material Doctrine (Doctrine Atlas §1)
- **ID:** MAT-003 (unchanged — keeps existing references intact)
- **Type:** `doctrine.material`
- **Holds:** Visual properties (gold/luminous seams on cracked surfaces), tactile

properties (raised seams), render rules, physical-product finish mappings (Vault Box seam detailing, Codex seals, Triptych accent lines).

- **References:** `parent: SYM-010`
- **Does NOT hold:** symbolic meaning (lives in parent), story logic (lives in sibling).
- **Status target:** Defined → Canon-Locked once render spec is written. **This decree unblocks that move.**

3.3 KINTSUGI-NARRATIVE — story-logic expression

- **Layer:** Narrative Atlas / Kintsugi Narrative planet
- **Proposed ID:** NAR-001 (establish NAR range)
- **Type:** `doctrine.narrative` (or `narrative.engine` per your Narrative Atlas schema)
- **Holds:** Fracture Event, repair-arc logic, branching and continuity rules, the post-Fracture recovery spine.
- **References:** `parent: SYM-010`
- **Does NOT hold:** render finishes (lives in sibling), the bare symbolic law (lives in parent).
- **Status target:** Defined; story-spine schema population now unblocked.

4. RESOLVER & PROTECTED-FIELDS CONSEQUENCES

- The TIR-1.1 resolver enforces against **KINTSUGI-MATERIAL (MAT-003)** only. The resolver is a render-time engine; it has no business reading story logic or bare symbolism. This keeps the resolver's protected-field surface narrow and auditable.
- Where a character's protected fields invoke Kintsugi (e.g. Calista → Kintsugi fingerprint, Isolde's Pearl tie to "broken but stronger"), the protected field points at **MAT-003** for render enforcement and may carry a **soft reference** to SYM-010 for narrative consistency checks — but SYM-010 is never resolver-enforced at render time.
- **Rule:** A protected field may be `hard` (resolver-enforced, render layer, MAT only) or `soft` (consistency-checked, not render-blocking, may point at SYM or NAR). Kintsugi forces this distinction into existence; adopt it system-wide.

5. WHY "LAYER" AND NOT "MERGE" OR "BRANCH"

- **Not MERGE:** the three are not the same object collapsed together; they are distinct types with different consumers (resolver vs story engine vs both).
- **Not BRANCH:** these are not divergent versions of one record; they coexist permanently and serve different layers at the same time.
- **LAYER is correct:** one concept expressed at three strata with a typed reference chain. Passes the Canon-Lock Test on all four gates — Identity (three IDs), Function (render / story / law, distinct), Location (Material / Narrative / Doctrine planets), Authority (parent = Operator-locked Doctrine).

6. THE GENERALIZABLE RULE (the real prize)

Kintsugi is not unique. **Obsidian has the same latent collision** — MAT-002 (volcanic fracture render) vs the Fracture Event it symbolizes vs the severance narrative. So does any material that carries story weight.

Adopt as standing law:

Any entity that has a physical fingerprint, a symbolic meaning, AND a story role is stratified, never partitioned. It resolves into a Doctrine parent (the law), a Material child (render), and/or a Narrative child (story), bound by one-way downward reference. The resolver enforces the Material child only.

This converts #04 from a one-off Kintsugi ruling into a reusable resolution pattern for every future material-with-meaning. Solve one, solve the class.

7. REGISTRY ACTIONS ON LOCK

1. Create **SYM-010 KINTSUGI-DOCTRINE**, status Canon-Locked, the symbolic law only.
2. Edit **MAT-003** to add `parent: SYM-010`, strip symbolic/narrative text down to render + finish, move status Named → Defined.
3. Create **NAR-001 KINTSUGI-NARRATIVE**, status Defined, `parent: SYM-010`.
4. Add the `hard / soft` protected-field distinction (§4) to the Protected Fields system spec.
5. Add §6 standing law to Black Governance as a resolution pattern; flag **MAT-002 Obsidian** for the same stratification review (open as Decree #04-b or fold into #08 roster work).
6. Update FGE-FULL-SYSTEM-MAP: MATERIAL and KINTSUGI NARRATIVE blockers for

#04 cleared; trigger Luminous Blue render-spec work on MAT-003.

8. WHAT THIS UNBLOCKS IMMEDIATELY

- MAT-003 can move toward Canon-Locked (render spec is now the only remaining gate, not the identity dispute).
- Kintsugi repair arcs that thread through Pearl/Isolde — your active revenue character — are no longer blocked by an unresolved Kintsugi identity.
- Triptych, Codex, Lookbook, and Vault Box finish design can proceed against a stable MAT-003.
- The story-spine schema for the Kintsugi Narrative planet can populate against NAR-001.

RULING STATUS: Ready for Canon Operator lock. **LOCK ACTION REQUIRED:** Operator confirms stratification model and authorizes the six registry actions in §7. **ON LOCK:** Decree #04 closes; ~18 blocked registry lines clear through MAT-003; Obsidian flagged for follow-up.

End of FGE-DECREE-04-KINTSUGI-PARTITION-v1.0